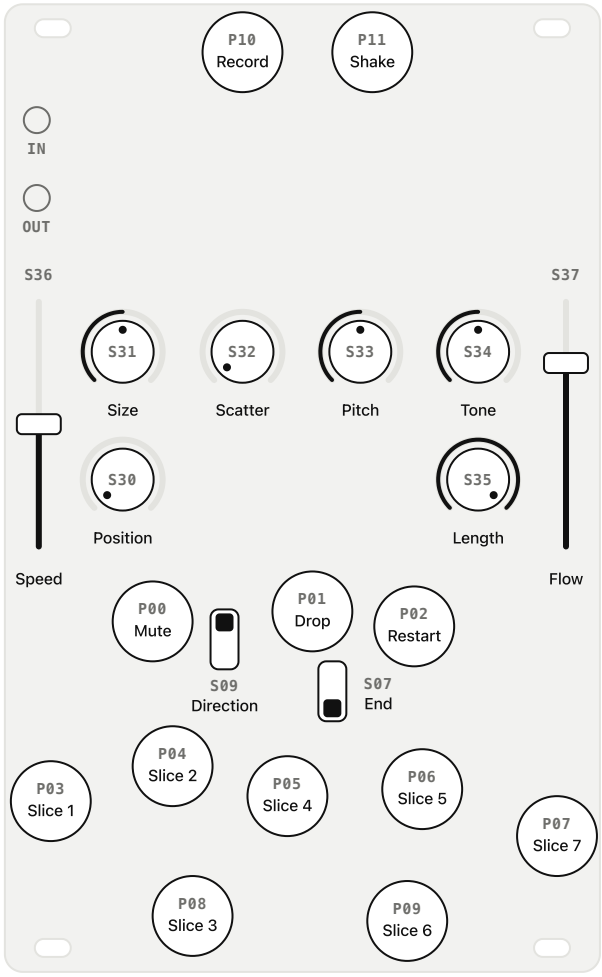
Simple Touch

Clessidra

It's the instrument where you pour grains of sound from single drops into a dense cloud.

francescodimaggio.nl/clessidra

Synthux Design Residency 2026



One layer: every control does one thing, where it is.

The selection is the sand. Speed sets how fast it runs through, Flow how it falls.

Flick S09 to turn the glass over.

FADERS AND KNOBS

S36	**Speed**. How fast the glass empties: stopped at the bottom, 1× at the centre, 4× at the top.
S37	**Flow**. The neck: closed, single drops, a stream, a cloud. Density, size, window, reverb.
S30	**Position**. Where the sand starts, anywhere in the recording. Held: moves the point.
S35	**Length**. How much sand: the selection, past the end round to the start.
S31	**Size**. Grain size: a quarter to four times Flow's, up to half the recording.
S32	**Scatter**. Plain at 0. Up: random starts, places, sizes, pan. Top quarter: pitch.
S33	**Pitch**. ±12 semitones. Stops at 0, 0.1, 5, 7, 12.
S34	**Tone**. Low-pass down, 20 kHz to 200 Hz. Off at the centre. High-pass up, to 2 kHz.

PADS AND SWITCHES

S09	**Direction**. Up forward, centre held, down reverse. Flicked: the glass turned over.
S07	**End**. When the sand runs out: up stops, centre turns over, down loops. Slices too.
P10	**Record**. Tap: the last seconds, as set. Hold: up to 30 s, the input heard.
P11	**Shake**. Held: Scatter towards the top, firmer for more. Let go, it settles.
P00	**Mute**. Held: the grains silent, the reverb rings on.
P01	**Drop**. A touch: one grain at the playhead, whatever Flow.
P02	**Restart**. The sand back to the top: the playhead to the selection start.
P03–P09	**Slices**. Plays its slice with its own grains, as End sets. Pressure opens its flow.

LED

Glow	Grains falling, dimmer as the sand runs out
Flashing	Recording
Pulse	At a centre: unison, speed 1×, Flow's size, tone off